Palbociclib with endocrine therapy

The usual palbociclib starting dose is 125 mg once daily; a lower dose may be prescribed. Palbociclib is taken once daily on Days 1–21, then paused on Days 22–28 of each 28-day cycle. The aromatase inhibitor continues daily, or fulvestrant follows its injection schedule. Ovarian suppression has its own plan when required.

Oral CDK4/6 inhibitor + hormone therapy · selected medicine-specific effects. Full details and sources are in the complete reference.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Blood counts

Palbociclib

Counts can fall without symptoms. Keep FBC appointments and report infection symptoms.

3 Mouth

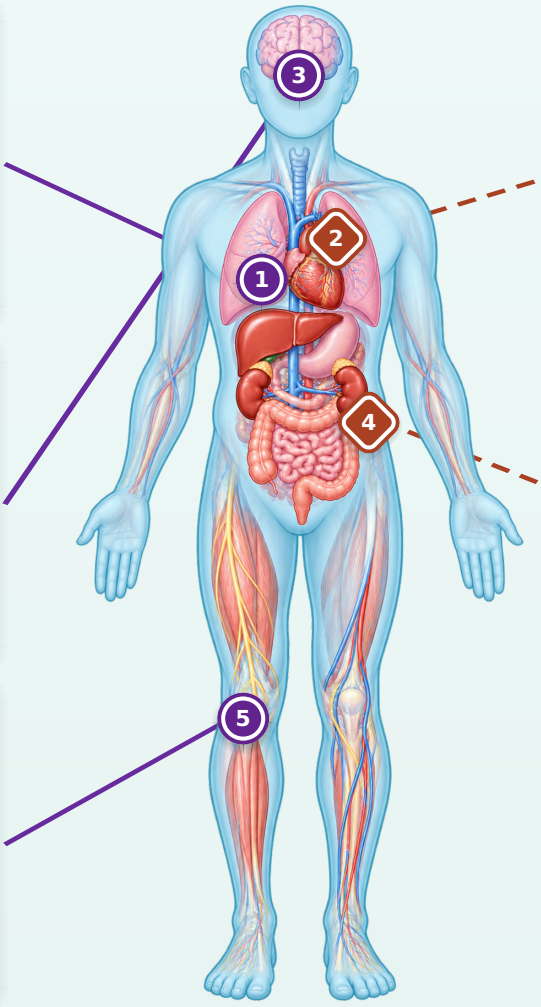
Palbociclib

Report painful sores or difficulty eating/drinking.

5 Joint / bone symptoms

Endocrine partner

AI and ovarian suppression may affect joints and bone; agree the partner-specific bone plan.



2 Lungs

Palbociclib

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt assessment for infection or uncommon lung inflammation.

4 Energy

Palbociclib

Report fatigue that limits activity or is worsening; blood counts and other causes may need review.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Contact the treatment team promptly if you feel feverish or unwell, have shaking chills or infection symptoms, or develop new cough or breathlessness. Follow the local emergency temperature instructions; do not wait for a planned blood test or for the 38.5°C value used in one clinician dose-adjustment table. Severe breathing difficulty needs emergency care. Severe chest pain, major breathing difficulty, collapse or stroke symptoms: 112 / 999.

YOUR PRACTICAL TREATMENT PLAN

Know the next step.

Taking treatment

The usual palbociclib starting dose is 125 mg once daily; a lower dose may be prescribed. Palbociclib is taken once daily on Days 1–21, then paused on Days 22–28 of each 28-day cycle. The aromatase inhibitor continues daily, or fulvestrant follows its injection schedule. Ovarian suppression has its own plan when required.

Check whether the pharmacy supplied capsules or tablets: capsules are taken with food; tablets can be taken with or without food. Swallow whole at a consistent time. Avoid grapefruit. If you miss or vomit a dose, do not take an extra dose; take the next scheduled dose. Do not restart after a clinical hold until the treating team confirms.

Checks and follow-up

FBC, renal and liver profile. Confirm receptor status, exact endocrine partner, previous endocrine therapy, menopause/ovarian suppression, pregnancy precautions and interacting medicines. FBC on Day 1 and Day 15 of cycles 1–2; Day 1 from cycle 3 and extra checks as indicated. Only after at most grade 1–2 neutropenia throughout the first six cycles may FBC monitoring reduce to every three months, before the start of a cycle and as indicated. Renal and liver profile before each cycle; review fever/infection, mouth/bowel symptoms, fatigue, pulmonary symptoms and adherence. No routine palbociclib-specific Day-14 ECG or echo timetable; investigate when clinically indicated.

The whole-treatment map shows the checks for this exact treatment setting.

Support between reviews

Nausea support

Palbociclib is oral minimal–low emetic risk. Premedication is not usually required; agree rescue treatment if symptoms occur.

Blood counts and infection

Attend early and pre-cycle blood tests. Dose holds and reductions are clinician decisions. Growth-factor injections are not a routine automatic prescription for every patient.

Endocrine-partner support

Agree help for hot flushes, joints, vaginal or sexual symptoms, sleep and bone health. Fulvestrant injection discomfort and any ovarian-suppression injections have separate support plans.

Formulation and interactions

Check whether the pack contains capsules or tablets and follow the food instructions for that product. Check new medicines, supplements and grapefruit interactions.

Symptoms between visits

Report mouth ulcers, persistent bowel symptoms, worsening fatigue, fever or new breathing symptoms promptly.

Oncology daytime: Insert numbers here. **Out of hours:** Insert numbers here. Follow your own hospital’s urgent-care plan. Emergency: 112 / 999.

Your complete treatment reference

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00414/

Public information only. No personal information is encoded.